hot & heavy

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Archive Warnings:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Flashbacks, Fluff, Hurt/Comfort, Light Angst, Implied/Referenced Child Abuse, School Dances, Childhood Friends, Childhood Memories, Post-High School, POV Adora (She-Ra), Oblivious Adora (She-Ra), Implied/Referenced Alcohol Abuse/Alcoholism, Unresolved Emotional Tension, Emotional Baggage, Adora is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), no beta we die like shadow weaver, First Kiss, Promises

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by Friend0fM4ra

Summary

Adora is on the train, coming back from her first year of university to spend the summer holidays in her hometown. On the way, she reminisces of easier times, when her and Catra were kids with an uncomplicated and unburdened friendship.

Notes

WOW i haven't posted in so long damn
i feel like i should've done this a long time ago considering my pfp and my username are both she-ra things, but here it is, my first she-ra fanfic!!
a list of songs that have inspired this fanfic:
- hot & heavy by Lucy Dacus (honestly her entire Home Video album matches the vibes but this one is literally the title so)
- used to be by Beach House
- freaking out the neighbourhood by Mac Demarco
- the adults are talking by The Strokes
- my boy - twin fantasy by Car Seat Headrest

See the end of the work for more notes

"I'm about to board the train!" Adora texts to her college friends Glimmer and Bow as it pulls to a stop in front of her. She drags her suitcase up the small steps, awkwardly apologising to the other passengers when one of the wheels get stuck and blocks the way up. Once she wrenches it free, she exiles herself to an empty end of the train to avoid embarrassing herself any further. It takes her another strenuous minute to shove her luggage into the compartment above her seat, but once she's sat down, she sees that her friends have already answered, wishing her a safe trip, and reminding her to text them when she gets home.

Home. She hasn't been there in so long; she doesn't know if she can even call it that anymore. This first year of university had been so demanding that she had spent all her free time in the city, never having the opportunity to travel all the way back to the small town she grew up in. Plus, it's not like there's much there for her anyways; her mother probably won't let her see her younger brother – they hadn't spoken since she came out this year – and she hasn't talked to most of her old friends in almost a year, though she knows that's mostly her fault. She hasn't been the easiest to keep up with over the past year, but she knows that even if she had been able to text consistently, their relationships would've been strained anyways because of her scholarship. People from her hometown never got scholarships – they never really got out of there at all – and though they were happy for her, she knew the unfairness of it all made everything complicated. And quite frankly, she was much happier with her new friends than she had ever been with her old ones anyway. They were funny, supportive, kind and open-minded in a way that people from her town usually weren't.

So, there's really only one reason that convinced her to go back during the summer break: Catra, her best friend since primary school. This was the first time that they had ever been away from each other, which felt… weird, to say the least. Whenever they managed to talk, which was usually later in the night, Catra was drunk more often than not, and when they video-called, there always seemed to be some bruises or scrapes on her. She had

always been a troublemaker, but never to this extent – though maybe that was thanks to Adora. She feels helpless now that she is incapable of protecting her anymore. She hates being so far away, unable to reach her, to comfort her – and selfishly, be comforted in one of the most challenging times of her life. But she also worries that these changes they are both going through, in opposite directions, means that their friendship won't be the same when she goes back.

During this past year, their relationship got tense. Whenever Adora talked about her college friends, she could hear the jealousy in Catra's voice, and when Catra talked about her troublemaking at school, Adora got concerned and sometimes frustrated at her. So, after a particularly bad phone call that ended with snide remarks from both of them, they both learned to avoid those subjects. But without talking about these crucial parts of their lives, they often ran out of things to say, which led to some awkward silences and shorter than usual phone calls. They had never been awkward before, and Adora didn't know what to do. Perhaps foolishly, she put it all off to when they would meet again, hoping that seeing each other in person would help them return to their naturally breezy and carefree ways. Now, she's stuck sitting in a train with no way of knowing if that will actually work, and maybe her friendship with Catra will never be the same again. Maybe she ruined it.

It's too late to be stressing about those things anymore, but Adora can't help thinking back to how things used to be between them – and how she hopes they will be again. She plugs her headphones in and rests her head on the windowsill as the music guides her on a trip through her memories.

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The bell rang shrilly, but it was quickly drowned out by the excited shrieks of the primary school students pouring out into the playground. Adora had been in this school since she was old enough to attend, and at seven years old and she already had a great reputation amongst students and teachers alike: friendly,

hard-working, and always willing to help out. So, when a new student unexpectedly joined their class halfway through the school year, they assigned Adora to show her around and help her integrate. But so far, things had not been going ideally.

Her name was Catra, and she was… feisty, to put it nicely. Judging by her constant sulking and snappy remarks, she very clearly hated being here. But one of Adora's biggest flaws was that she never gave up.

The problem here wasn't necessarily her bad mood, but more what it would do to the people around her. As in, Catra seemed to make a point of starting fights with as many people as possible, and though Adora was friends with everyone in her class, it was getting more and more complicated to keep everyone from fighting back. Even her teacher suggested that maybe she should let it go, since it was causing way more harm than good for her to keep trying to socialise with Catra. But it made Adora sad, seeing her wander around the playground on her own, eyes on the ground and arms dangling. Nothing to do, no one to do it with.

So, she kept trying. And trying, and trying, and trying, until one day, she cracked.

"Hey Catra! Do you want to join us? Lonnie, me, Kyle and Rogelio are playing tag!"

"Why would I want to do that? It sounds stupid." Catra huffed. It made Adora's cheerfulness falter a bit, but she paid it no mind.

"It's not stupid. It's fun!"

She scoffed. "That sounds like something someone stupid would say. What's it like being the world's stupidest person, Adora?" She giggled and snorted at her own joke, and it made Adora's cheeks go red.

Granted, looking back at it now it's very laughable, but at the time, that insult was devastating.

“Fine! If you want to be alone so bad, then I-I’ll leave you alone, and you can keep playing with no one, like- like a loser!” Adora stormed off, frustration running through her and tears pricking at her eyes. By the time she joined her friends again, she was sniffing and crying, babbling about how she didn’t understand how someone could be so mean. Then, just as she was calming down, she realised that what she did was just as mean and started crying even harder.

After that, she didn’t try talking to Catra again for a week. But without her defending Catra, her classmates got meaner and meaner towards her, and not even the teacher managed to stop all of it. One day, Adora was looking for her friends during the break, and found them fighting with Catra – or at least, found Lonnie fighting with her, with Kyle and Rogelio looking both scared and aggressive behind her. Adora didn’t hear most of it, but she heard enough to know she arrived just in time.

“Oh yeah?! Well, I heard your mom didn’t even love you enough to be your mom!” Lonnie yelled, and it set off something violent in Catra. Her eyes widened, and Adora saw the deep hurt in them. Just as Catra was about to jump at Lonnie, Adora stepped in between them.

“Stop it guys! Why are you both so angry?! It shouldn’t be that hard just to get along.”

“She started it!” “She’s insane!” They both said at the same time, but Adora was having none of it.

“Stop!” She took a deep breath and started again. “Alright, you’re gonna shake each other’s hands and say sorry for being mean.” They looked hesitant, but after a fierce look thrown her way, Lonnie stuck her hand out with a roll of her eyes. Catra was looking anywhere but Adora’s face, but her insisting unbroken stare still worked its magic, and they shook hands.

Adora, proud of herself, smiled and said, “Good. Now say you’re sorry.”

Surprisingly, Catra started. “I’m-sorry-I-called-your-face-dumb-and-I’m-sorry-I-stole-your-pen-and-I’m-sorry-I-called-you-a-stupid-idiot.” She was looking at the ground while she sped through her apology, cheeks tinted red, but when she was done, she looked at Adora expectantly. She nodded approvingly, and Catra smiled proudly.

Then, Lonnie recited her apology, trying hard to pretend she didn’t care, but she was blushing just the same. “I’m sorry I laughed at you in math class, and I’m sorry I said that thing about your mom. There. I said it. Can I go now?”

“Only if you promise not to fight again.” Adora answered, and they both grunted frustratedly, but agreed nonetheless.

Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio left together, and Adora was about to follow them when she felt a finger timidly tap on her shoulder. She turned, and Catra was fidgeting with the edge of her too long t-shirt, face red as a tomato. “Can I play tag now?” Adora smiled, then laughed a bit, but it made Catra’s face go even redder.

“What?! What’s so funny?”

“Nothing, nothing.” She reassured. “I’m just happy. Now come on.” Adora extended her hand towards her, and the glint of joy in tiny Catra’s heterochrome eyes when she took her hand is an image that Adora will remember forever.

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Adora had always been a light sleeper, rarely feeling relaxed enough to fall into deep slumber. Naturally, after many nights of sleeping in the same bed, having to squeeze together tighter and tighter each time as their limbs grew awkwardly fast, Catra knew that. So, she knew that when she threw a few acorns at Adora’s bedroom window at 1 in the morning, Adora’s face would peek out of her curtains shortly after.

“Hey, Adora” Catra whisper-shouted from below, a sheepish smile on her face. Adora didn’t even bother answering, too tired to

make a sound, and just went down to the front door. A shiver ran through her when she stepped outside, and she wrapped the quilt she had dragged from her bed even tighter around herself. "You look like a dork." Catra said as she jogged to her.

"Could say the same 'bout you." Adora yawned, referring to Catra's mismatched socks, toothpaste-stained shirt, and disheveled mouse-brown hair. "Lot of wind tonight?"

"As a matter of fact, yes." Catra said, proudly refusing to fix her hair.

"Why are you here?" Adora asked, concern tinging her voice. She knew not to make her worries about Catra too obvious, because if there's one thing Catra hated more than anything, it was seeming weak. Adora had told her time and time again that she would never judge her, but even though they had been friends since they were seven – which was now half of their lives already – Catra still refused to let herself be vulnerable around her, or anyone really.

"Eh, not much really, it's just-" Her eyes met Adora's, and her shields faltered a bit. "I went for a uh, a nice little midnight walk and accidentally got locked out of my house," she rushed out the lie, trying to sound nonchalant but not managing very well "and I was wondering, if I could, maybe, sleep here tonight?"

Adora tried her best to conceal it, but Catra saw the ache in her eyes. She took it as unease, discomfort at being forced to deal with her messes again, and immediately tried to backtrack. "I mean, it's okay if you don't want to, I get it, it's fine. Actually it was a stupid idea to come here, I should know better, I promise I won't bother you anymore."

Just as she was turning around to leave, a hand gently landed on her wrist and pulled her back in. Before she could resist, two arms enveloped her with the rest of the blanket, trapping her in the warmest hug they had ever shared. Catra's breath was shaky on Adora's neck as her fingers tightened in her shirt, both of them

willing themselves not to cry. “Of course you can stay tonight, Catra. You can stay here whenever you want.”

Catra didn’t thank her, but Adora felt her nodding in the crook of her neck, and a cool drop landed on her shoulder, though she pretended not to notice for Catra’s sake. Soon after, they went back inside, still holding onto each other under the blanket. When they reached the bed, Adora collapsed onto it and Catra curled up against her, refusing to look her in the eye. But she didn’t need to – Adora knew what to do, she always did. Her fingers waded through Catra’s tangled hair to get to her scalp and there she started scratching like she would a cat. She could swear she heard her purr.

After a long moment of comfortable silence in which Adora was starting to doze off, Catra spoke up. “Do you want to skip school tomorrow?”

“Uh, I don’t know.” Adora sighed. “Do you have any tests?”

“What? Me, skipping a test? Quite frankly I’m offended that you think I would do something like that.” Catra exclaimed with dramatic sarcasm, only to be met with Adora’s ‘I’m having none of this’ face. “Chill out, bossy boots. I don’t have any tests tomorrow.”

“Well okay then, but in any case I’ll have to wake up early to make breakfast for my brother.” Adora says as she turns to lie on her back, hand still tangled in Catra’s hair.

“I’m fine with that. I can help you.” Catra answers.

“Nah, should be fine. But thank you.” Adora yawns. “What would you even want to do?”

“Uhh,” Catra exhales, “You still have some of those firecrackers from that prank we pulled on Kyle the other day?” Adora nods. “I guess we could go light these by Mrs. Octavia’s house for old times sake? Ruin her garden a bit?”

Adora laughs. “Wow, you’re evil.”

“Shut up.” Catra scoffs, pushing Adora’s side with a smile on her face.

The next day, they went to their old teacher’s house and threw the firecrackers on her porch, leaving scorch marks on her door and her chihuahua barking madly. They ran away hand in hand before her furious voice could catch up with them, just as they did when they were kids – well, younger ones at least.

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Exam season had come and gone without Adora even noticing, but that might be the leftover anxiety and caffeine in her system talking. She had graduated valedictorian of her shitty small town high school, which is a title she tried to carry without too much pride. It earned her a scholarship to one of her dream universities, but she felt guilty to be leaving this place, her family, and especially Catra behind.

Catra had gotten into a lot of trouble, too much trouble, during their junior year. Adora knew it was because of her situation at home. She had been stuck into a foster home with adults who didn’t care about her in the slightest yet took every opportunity possible to criticize her, or worse. With no other way to sort out her problems, her passive aggressive comments to teachers turned into insults, skipping classes to catch up on graded homework turned into smoking in the bathroom and setting off the fire alarms, and she failed her junior year. She took it over again, but it created a small drift in their relationship. Without taking the same classes, without having the same timetables, they both found themselves lonelier than usual, and it had made things… a bit weird. Adora had offered her academic help whenever she could, but Catra usually deflected onto other subjects whenever school came up, preferring to pretend that nothing had changed between them, maybe even that nothing would ever change again.

However, tonight was the only night that Adora was willing to go along with that. It was her prom night, and she naturally invited Catra as her plus one. They were getting ready in Adora's room. Catra had been convinced after five minutes of constant pleads from Adora to wear makeup, which included mascara, tinted lip balm and some eyeliner she immediately smudged, which neither of them bothered to fix. Adora thought it suited her better that way. Then again, in her opinion everything suited Catra. In retaliation for the makeup, Catra had made Adora swear not to wear her hair up tonight, which she unhappily abided by. She opted for a lose braid crown to keep her shorter front strands out of her face, with the rest of her hair falling in waves over her shoulders.

They both got dressed separately, planning to reveal their outfits at the same moment – as if they hadn't gone shopping for them together for matching clothes, and they were still a surprise. But the only thing they hadn't seen yet was each other wearing the clothes.

"Ready?" Adora called from the bathroom right next to her bedroom.

"Yup!" Catra exclaimed, sitting on her bed with the door open to hear her better.

Adora stepped out in a red dress with two layers of fabric, a thicker and softer one against her and a sheer flowy one on top, which floated as she twirled. It was sinched at the waist with a thin golden belt which matched her sandals and complimented her blond hair. The thin layers of makeup on her face reflected the colors of her outfit, glossy red on her lips and soft gold on her eyes.

Catra stood up to see her better, and Adora took the opportunity to admire her as well. She wore a dark burgundy suit with a shirt the same vibrant red as Adora's dress. Her bowtie was hanging undone around her collar and her sleeves were pulled up, but

Adora knew better than to try to take away her only chance to look rebellious in those somewhat fancy clothes.

"You look great – amazing!" They said at the same time, almost squealing with excitement, immediately reaching out for each other's hands.

"Are you ready to go, m'lady?" Catra asked jokingly.

"Of course, kind sir. Just need my bag." Adora went to her bedroom, retrieved her handbag, and when she closed the door behind her Catra was waiting with her arm out, which she gladly took.

Downstairs, the television was on playing her young brother's favorite cartoon. "Adam?" She called out and received a "Yeesssssss?" as an answer. "Mom's gonna be home in about" she checked her watch "an hour. There's already food in the fridge, you just need to put it in the microwave. Don't stay up too late!"

"I won't!" Adam called out, clearly lying. "Have fun! But not too much." He followed teasingly with a bunch of kissing noises, in true eleven-year-old fashion.

Adora rolled her eyes and smiled. "Alright, bye then!"

They made their way to the high school, which was about ten minutes away from Adora's house. The gym was covered in hand-cut paper banners, most of which Adora had worked on with the rest of the student council, and the lights coated everything and everyone with hues of blue and pink. Catra's eyes reflected the colors in a hypnotic way, Adora couldn't stop staring at her.

They sat down at a table on the edge of the dancefloor, waiting for the music to get more upbeat to start dancing. The current tune was slow and soft, barely audible to them, and in the center of the room there were only a few couples swaying together, so sure they will stay together forever, or perhaps secretly saying their goodbyes. Adora and Catra busied themselves by trying to guess how long it'll take them to break up once they leave high

school. For a moment, as Catra snorted at one of Adora's jokes, she wondered if people were saying the same things about them; but she reminded herself that it wouldn't make any sense, as Catra and her weren't dating and certainly didn't have any intentions to do so. Then again, from an outsider perspective, they were always glued to the hip, barely ever seen with anyone else, and came to prom in matching outfits for god's sake.

Whatever. If people thought that about them, let them. It didn't matter much. If they asked she would correct them, of course, but right now she's not against just… letting them.

She didn't quite realize that Catra had also gone quiet, so they both sat staring at each other, lost in their own minds. Except Catra's face had a slight frown weighing on her brows, and Adora's was pulled up by a small smile. They could sit in silence all night for all she cared, and she would still be the happiest girl here.

But Catra had other plans for them. Her smile returned when finally, a danceable song came on. Specifically, Dancing Queen by ABBA. And everyone knows you can't refuse to dance to this song. So, without even asking, she took Adora's hand and pulled her out of her seat, running for the dancefloor along with most other kids in the room.

Adora was shy at first, not sure what to do with herself, but Catra made it clear with her exaggerated – bordering on ridiculous – dance moves that neither did she. It made Adora laugh, which Catra looked very pleased about, and soon enough they were both dancing like complete idiots, screaming the lyrics into each other's faces. Earlier in the night, as Adora was excitedly fussing over her makeup, Catra had insisted she only agreed to come to this stupid thing because Adora asked her to, but now she looked like she was having the most fun out of all of them. They were in one of those rare moments of complete freedom and carelessness, allowing themselves to simply exist in the midst of people who either cared too much or too little about them. Song after song, they stayed in this unbroken bubble for about an hour,

after which people slowly left the floor to fetch drinks and food and rest, and the music reverted to slower rhythms.

They both stopped dancing, standing still in front of each other, awkwardly aware of the curious looks people were throwing their way. Catra was glancing at the people slow-dancing around them, and when she looked back to meet Adora's eyes, it seemed that she was about to speak, her eyebrows raised ever so slightly in a way that signaled a question. But then, she
shook her head almost unnoticeably and instead asked Adora if they should leave.

"I mean, this place doesn't even serve alcohol." She said, chuckling. "And now that the music's all lame again, I figured we could just head out and listen to our own music." Adora, not thinking much of this at the time, said yes.

She realizes now what her original question probably was and wishes she would've taken Catra's hand that night and stayed to dance with her in a slower, gentler way, leaving no place for doubt in Catra's mind about her feelings for her. But their town was never known to be the most welcoming of people like them, and she knows why Catra wanted them to leave all those judgmental eyes.

After quickly buying some cheap vodka from a storeowner who knew they weren't of age but was too tired to care, they headed to a field at the top of the hill their town was built on, which almost no one came to during the day and no one ever came to during the night. It was something about the unkempt, tall grasses filled with mice and bugs and the underlying mud which drove people away, but Catra and Adora had been playing in that field forever, and they knew where to walk in order to reach the spot where the grass was shorter and softer, hidden from prying eyes by the surrounding bushes, perfect for secret picnics and stargazing. The view here was the prettiest in town. Looking down at their houses and up at the sky, it felt like they could actually get away from it all.

They each took a swig from the bottle. Adora coughed a bit as it went down her throat, burning her slightly. She never got the hang of it quite like Catra did. Catra, who as she drank took her phone out and played the one of the shared playlists they had, the one for upbeat songs specifically made for moments like these. It was a mix of Catra's rock songs and Adora's pop songs that they had each come to know quite well; even when they weren't hanging out, Adora would listen to that playlist to feel as though Catra was there with her *(and she still does)*. She suspected Catra did the same, as she knew the lyrics to her songs a bit too well for someone who supposedly hated mainstream music. They drank and danced until their heads felt light and their legs heavy, and then they sat together, shoulder to shoulder, staring out at the stars. All the lights reflected beautifully into Catra's wide eyes, sparkling like they held the whole world in them. And for Adora, they did.

It hit her again that this was the last summer they would ever spend together like this. Even if she liked to think that college wouldn't change much between them, she knew better than to think it wouldn't change anything at all. This was the last summer they would spend as kids, running around in fields, running away from – but more often running towards – trouble. Being free to run wherever and whenever they wanted.

A wave of sadness crashed over her as Catra rested her head on her shoulder, but she took a deep breath and let it wash away. She had promised herself she wouldn't think about these things tonight. Instead, she let herself relax and put her head on top of Catra's. They sat like that for a while, occasionally passing the bottle between them, but it remained mostly filled. Though neither of them said it, Adora knew they were both being careful to stay fully present in this moment together. Their fingers found each other in the grass, gently entangling together. The playlist eventually ran out of songs to play, so instead they listened to the soft sound of crickets and the distant hum of traffic.

Adora knew they were both too emotional to start a sconversation now. The silence was comfortable, as always between them, but it

was heavy with unspoken emotions. Adora's heart squeezed. She would be leaving soon, not just leaving the school or the town but the state altogether, and she wanted to let Catra know just how much she meant to her, let her know that she would always be there for her, even with physical distance between them… but she didn't know how to.

Unexpectedly, Catra was the one to speak up first. She turned to sit in front of Adora but didn't bother to put more distance between them, which left them sitting knee to knee and as she leaned over, almost nose to nose with her. Adora made no effort to move away. "Promise me," she started, voice a little watery. She cleared her throat of it and began again. "Promise me you'll come back here. Promise me you won't leave me."

Over the years, they had had a number of promises that so far had gone unbroken, but at heart they were all the same. *Promise you'll stay, unlike the others. Promise you'll help me, unconditionally. Promise you can give me what I need. Promise me you love me.*

Adora's voice was shaky with held back tears as she answered. "I promise." Her hand tightened around Catra's. She felt her move before she saw it, and suddenly Catra's other hand was cupping her jaw and her soft lips were on her own. A tear fell down Adora's cheek when she closed her eyes to savor the moment; but when it reached their lips Catra suddenly broke away and stood up, refusing to look at her.

"I should go home. Samantha will be mad if I get back late." Catra mumbled and swiftly left without another word, bottle of vodka in hand.

Adora sat in that field for longer than she cares to admit. Her mind, her face, her stare – everything went blank, yet the tears kept streaming down her cheeks. They released a tension in her shoulders that she didn't know she had. This was something that she had wanted, needed for so long, and never even realized it. What an idiot she could be sometimes. What idiots they both

were. Adora, always too focused on the future to see what was always in front of her, and Catra, too stuck in the past to think of the possibilities.

When Adora left the field, she really wanted to have her own bottle of vodka to take home.

After three unanswered texts the next day, Adora gave up on trying to talk to Catra for the moment. She would come to her when she was ready, she always did. Then, one sunny afternoon a few days after prom, Catra had showed up under Adora's window and called her to join her outside. She did so without hesitation. While they walked to nowhere in particular, they eventually settled into a comfortable silence – well, it would've been comfortable, except for the fact that Catra seemed to purposefully avoid Adora's eyes, and that Adora was worrying her lower lip between her teeth. Nonetheless, she gathered her courage and asked "Listen, about the prom night- I just wanted to talk. About what happened."

Catra kept walking, even as Adora stopped. "What? What happened?" She asked in a way that didn't invite an answer.

Adora knew neither of them were drunk enough to not remember it. She didn't think she could forget it if she tried. But she understood the subtle warning in Catra's voice to not bring it up. She didn't really understand why Catra didn't want to talk about it, but she knew better than to pick this fight. She was leaving soon, and she didn't want to risk ruining whatever time they had left of their last summer together.

So, neither of them mentioned it. Adora left not knowing whether the girl she loved – had always loved – truly loved her back, and she came back knowing even less.

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A year has passed since then, but Adora still feels as confused and nervous about seeing Catra as she did last summer. So much has

happened, so much has gone unsaid, will it still be possible for them to fall back into their old habits of carefree laughter and shameless intimacy? She is willing do anything to get that back. She would give up on her unconditional love for Catra if it meant knowing they could go back to that. But she also knows it's not only up to her.

As her train pulls into the tiny station of her hometown, she texts Glimmer and Bow to let them know her train didn't crash and burn during the journey. She awkwardly yanks her suitcase out of the compartment above the seats, and it almost lands on an old man's head. Adora apologizes profusely, but seeing the judgmental look in his eyes, she decides to scurry away before the embarrassed pink in her cheeks turns into a violent red.

Once she's off the train, she starts looking for Catra around the small crowd of people weaving in every direction. She said that she would be picking her up, but it was such a brief discussion almost a month ago that Adora wasn't sure she remembered it. But just as she pulls her phone out to send a text to Catra, she spots her by a signpost, on her tiptoes looking through the crowd, probably unable to see above anyone's head. As she walks to her, she notices the crooked carboard sign in her hands that spells her name in bold but shaky black letters, and the haphazardly tied bouquet of small wildflowers that Adora recognizes from their field. She smiles and walks as fast as she can towards her with her suitcase bouncing off her heels. Catra's head turns at the noise, and her smile when she sees Adora is brighter than the sun. God, she missed her so much.

Catra gives a small wave as Adora reaches her, eyes jumping around furiously as they try to take all of her in at once. Then, breathlessly, almost disbelievingly, she whispers "Hey, Adora" with a pink tinge surfacing beneath her freckles, and Adora knows that whatever will happen between them, they can work it out, together.

End Notes

i hope you enjoyed this!
it might have a sequel if i ever get bored, but probably not because im working on a fucking HUGE fanfic for another fandom (cough cough mozart x salieri cough) and that's gonna be the main focus here for the time being
another fandom i might write for is good omens, but no promises
if that sounds interesting to you feel free to stick around i will be very thankful :))
and thanks to @GhostingALot for being the first to read this and giving me ur thoughts they were vvery helpful as always pls keep giving them

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!